



Official website of the Department of Homeland Security

On July 17, 2026, DHS [published](#) a final rule establishing a fixed time period for academic students, J exchange visitors and representatives of foreign information.



Homeland
Security

STUDY in the **STATES**

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SCHOOLS

BLOG

Training (CPT)

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F-1 Curricular Practical Training (CPT)

F-1 CURRICULAR PRACTICAL TRAINING (CPT)

Last updated: April 28, 2025

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Overview

Some F-1 students are eligible for practical training. There are two types of F-1 practical training: curricular practical training (CPT) and optional practical training (OPT).

Type of Practical Training	Distinction
	• Training relates directly to the student’s major area of study. • Training is an integral part of the school’s established curriculum. • Designated school official (DSO) authorized CPT in SEVIS, and the authorization prints on the student’s Form I-20. • Occurs <i>before</i> the student’s program end date on the Form I-

(CIP)

Dependents

Request/Authorizat
Details

Sample
Form I-20

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Information

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and
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Corrections
and
Correction
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F/M Status

F/M
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Employment

Planning
Tool for
24-Month
Extension
of STEM
OPT

Curricular Practical Training (CPT)	20. • Authorization is for one specific employer and for a specific period of time. • Student must secure the training opportunity before CPT can be authorized. • CPT must be authorized before the student can begin work. • Student can have more than one CPT authorization at the same time. • One year of full-time CPT eliminates a student’s eligibility for OPT.
Optional Practical Training (OPT)	• Training relates directly to the student’s major area of study. • DSO recommends OPT in SEVIS. • Student does not have to secure training before the DSO can recommend OPT. • Authorized by the U.S. Citizenship and Immigration Service (USCIS), and the student is issued an Employment Authorization Document (EAD). • Allows the student to work for any employer, as long as the training relates to the student’s major course of study

Planning Tool for Post Completion OPT
Student Employment Overview
View Employment Information
Unemployment Counter
F-1 Off Campus Employment and International Organization Internship
F-1 Curricular Practical Training (CPT)
F-1 Optional Practical Training (OPT)

- Can occur *before* or *after* the student’s program end date.
- Periods of OPT cannot overlap.
- Students are eligible for an additional 12 months of OPT authorization, when they change to a higher educational level.

This article focuses on CPT.



The following articles on the SEVIS Help Hub provide useful information about student employment:

- [Student Employment Overview](#)
- [F-1 Optional Practical Training](#)
- [View Employment Information](#)

F-1 Add,
Edit,
Delete
Optional
Practical
Training
(OPT)
Employer

F-1 STEM
Optional
Practical
Training
(OPT)
Extension

M-1
Practical
Training

SEVIS
and the
SEVP
Portal

Manage
Program
Dates,
Registration
and Course
Load

Transfers

Update
Student
Records

REGULATIONS AND POLICY

SEVIS Basics

School
Records

Complex rules apply to CPT because the training opportunity must comply with both:

- Federal regulations
- School policies regarding internships, experiential learning, etc.

Designated school officials must understand the following federal regulations and policy guidance to determine if a student qualifies for CPT:



Regulations applicable to CPT:

- [8 Code of Federal Regulations \(CFR\) 214.2\(f\)\(10\)](#) and (f)(10(i))
- <https://www.ice.gov/sevis/practical-training> [Practical Training page on ICE.gov](#)

ELIGIBILITY

A DSO can authorize CPT for an F-1 student enrolled at an SEVP-certified college, university, conservatory, or seminary if the student:

- Has been lawfully enrolled on a full-time basis for at least a full academic year.

Note: An exception exists for students in graduate studies whose programs require earlier training.

- Is not studying English as a second language.
- Has secured a training position.



CPT authorization is only required when the training is inside the United States. For example, a summer internship in a student's home country does not need CPT authorization.

CPT PROCESS OVERVIEW

step	Player	Action
1	Student	• Requests CPT using the school's established processes.
2	DSO	• Reviews request and determines student's eligibility for CPT.
3	DSO	• Authorizes CPT in SEVIS for a specific employer. • Prints and signs Form I-20 with CPT authorization.
4	Student	• Begins work on or after the CPT start date. Note: The student cannot start work prior to the start date. All work must end by the CPT end date.

Authorize CPT

To authorize curricular practical training:

1. Go to the *Student Information* page.

Student Information

Reprint I-20 | Print Draft I-20

F-1 STUDENT
Finn, Huckleberry

SEVP School for Advanced SEVIS Studies
- SEVP School for Advanced SEVIS Studies
Start Date: September 1, 2014 End Date: September 20, 2017

Status: **ACTIVE**
Status Change Date: April 13, 2015
SEVIS ID: N0004703370

View:
Event History

Request/Authorization Details
I-901 Fee Paid | I-20 ISSUE REASON: CONTINUED ATTENDANCE

Employment Information

Actions:
Authorize To Drop Below Full Course

Personal / Contact [Edit](#)

Sex: **MALE**
U.S. Address: **320 23RD ST S, ARLINGTON, VA 22202 - 3738**
Date of Birth: [REDACTED]
Address Status: [REDACTED]

Transfer Out
Verify Status

Employment/Training:
[CPT Employment Authorization](#)

Education, Level:
MASTER'S
Major 1 and Name: [REDACTED]

Initial Session Start Date
September 1, 2014
Current Session End Date
May 15, 2017
Next Session Start Date
August 15, 2017
Length of Next Break/Vacation
91
Last Session
Study/Research Abroad
No

Off-Campus Employment
Program Start Date: **September 1, 2014**
Program End Date: [REDACTED]

OPT Request

2. Click **CPT Employment Authorization** in the Employment/Training section of the links on the left-hand side of the page. The *CPT Employment* page opens.

SEVP School for Advanced SEVIS Studies

CPT Employment

F-1 Student
Finn, Huckleberry

SEVP School for Advanced SEVIS Studies -
SEVP School for Advanced SEVIS Studies
Start Date: 09/01/2014 End Date: 09/20/2017

Status: **ACTIVE**
SEVIS ID: N0004703370

[New CPT Employment](#)

No employment data found for student

[Return](#) [Print I-20](#)

3. Click **New CPT Employment**. The *Add CPT Employment* page opens.

Add CPT Employment

Required fields are marked with an asterisk (*).

1. * Employment Start Date:	(MM/DD/YYYY)
2. * Employment End Date:	(MM/DD/YYYY)
3. * Full Time/Part Time:	
4. * Employer Name:	
5. Employer Address:	Add Employer Address
6. Explain how the employment is curricular:	
7. Employment Remarks:	
8. Student Remarks: (This text will print on page 1 of the Form I-20.)	

4. Complete the following fields:

- **Employment Start Date:** Enter the date the CPT training is to begin. Format MM/DD/YYYY. This is a required field.



CPT Start Date must be on or after the date that CPT is authorized in SEVIS.

Students cannot legally work before CPT is authorized in SEVIS.

- **Employment End Date:** Enter the date the CPT training will end. Format MM/DD/YYYY. This is a required field.
- **Full Time/Part Time:** Indicate whether the training is full or part time. This is a required field.
 - **Full Time:** More than 20 hours per week
 - **Part Time:** 20 hours or less per week



DSOs must authorize CPT either on a part-time or full-time basis, in accordance with the school policies. When school is in session, the student must maintain a full course of study even when CPT is authorized.

- **Employer Name:** Enter the name of the company or organizations where the training will take place. This is a required field.
- Click **Add Employer Address:** Enter the address where the training will take place in the *Add Address* modal. This is a required field. See the [Address Standards](#) article in the Help Hub.
- **Explain how the employment is curricular:** Describe

how the training is an integral part of the established curriculum. These comments display on the *Employment Information* page. Completing this field is highly recommended. (250-character limit)

- **Employment Remarks:** Enter any optional remarks about the employment. These comments display on the *Current Request/Authorizations* page. (250-character limit)
- **Student Remarks:** Enter any remarks about the training. These remarks print on the Form I-20. They also display on the *Student Information* page until they are overwritten in the future. (1,000-character limit)

Note: SEVIS displays any comments previously entered for the student. You can choose to retain those comments, add new comments to them, or completely overwrite those comments.

5. Click one of the following: **Add Employment**, **Reset Values**, or **Cancel**.

- **Add Employment:** Adds the CPT authorization to the student record. An *Update Successful* page opens. Select either **Return to Employment List** or **Print I-20**:

Update Successful

[Return to Employment List](#)

[Print I-20](#)

- **Return to Employment List:** Returns to the CPT Employment page.
- **Print I-20:** Prints the Form I-20 with the CPT authorization on page two.



- Students are expected to keep all Forms I-20 issued during their academic career.
 - When information on the Form I-20 changes, it is best to give a new copy to the student.
 - Find more information on allowable electronic signatures and Form I-20 transmission in SEVP's policy guidance .
-
- **Reset Values:** Clears any values you entered.
 - **Cancel:** Returns to the *CPT Employment* page without authorizing CPT.

Cancel CPT

DSOs can cancel curricular practical training before the CPT start date. After the CPT start date, the DSO can only edit the authorization to shorten the CPT end date.

To cancel CPT for a student:

1. Go to the *CPT Employment* page.

SEVP School for Advanced SEVIS Studies

CPT Employment

F-1 Student

Finn, Huckleberry

SEVP School for Advanced SEVIS Studies -
SEVP School for Advanced SEVIS Studies
Start Date: 09/01/2014 End Date:
09/20/2017

Status: **ACTIVE**

SEVIS ID: **N0004703370**



New CPT Employment

Employer Name	FT/PT	Request Status	Employment	Command
SEVP Applied Labs	PT	APPROVED	Start: 02/01/2017 End: 05/30/2017	Edit Cancel
Great Employer	FT	APPROVED	Start: 09/02/2014 End: 10/31/2014	Edit

[Return](#) [Print 1-20](#)

2. Click **Cancel** in the Command column for the CPT authorization you want to remove. The *Cancel CPT Employment* page opens.

SEVP School for Advanced SEVIS Studies

Cancel CPT Employment

Full Time/Part Time: **PART TIME**
Employer Name: **SEVP Applied Labs**
Employer Address: **126 N. Wayne St.
Arlington
VIRGINIA
22201**

Explain how the employment is curricular: **Student's degree requires successful completion of an internship. Student is enrolled in an internship class to fulfill this requirement.**

Employment Remarks:

[Cancel Employment](#)

[Return](#)

SEVP School for Advanced SEVIS Studies**CPT Employment**

F-1 Student

Finn, Huckleberry

**SEVP School for Advanced SEVIS Studies -
SEVP School for Advanced SEVIS Studies**
Start Date: 09/01/2014 End Date:
09/20/2017

Status: **ACTIVE**
SEVIS ID: **N0004703370**

**New CPT Employment**

Employer Name	FT/PT	Request Status	Employment	Command
SEVP Applied Labs	PT	APPROVED	Start: 02/01/2017 End: 05/30/2017	Edit Cancel
Rival Lab	PT	CANCELLED	Start: 02/01/2017 End: 03/30/2017	View 
Great Employer	FT	APPROVED	Start: 09/02/2014 End: 10/31/2014	Edit

[Return](#) [Print I-20](#)

3. Review the information. Click either **Cancel Employment** or **Return**.

- **Cancel Employment:** Cancels the CPT authorization. An *Update Successful* page opens. Click either **Return to Employment List** or **Print I-20**:
 - **Return to Employment List:** Opens the *CPT Employment* page.
 - **Print I-20:** Prints the Form I-20.

- Students are expected to keep all Forms I-20 issued during their academic career.
 - When information on the Form I-20 changes, it is best to give a new copy to the student.
 - Find more information on allowable electronic signatures and Form I-20 transmission in SEVP's policy guidance .
-
- **Return:** Takes you back to the *CPT Employment* page without canceling CPT.

Note: SEVIS continues to display canceled CPT authorizations. They are part of the history of actions taken on the student's record.

Edit CPT

DSOs can edit CPT authorizations to defer, update, or shorten the authorization. To edit CPT:

1. Go to the *CPT Employment* page.
2. Click **Edit** next to the CPT authorization you want to update. The *Edit CPT Employment* page opens.

3. Update the field(s) that needs to be edited.

4. Click **Update Employment, Reset Values, or Cancel.**

- **Update Employment:** Edits the CPT authorization in the student record. An *Update Successful* page opens. Select either **Return to Employment List** or **Print I-20:**
- **Return to Employment List:** Returns to the *CPT Employment* page.
- **Print I-20:** Prints the Form I-20 with the edited CPT authorization on page two.



- Students are expected to keep all Forms I-20 issued during their academic career.
- When information on the Form I-20 changes, it is best to give a new copy to the student.



- Find information on allowable electronic signatures and Form I-20 transmission in SEVP's policy guidance [Use of Electronic Signatures and Transmission for the Form I-20](#).
- **Reset Values:** Clears any values you entered.
- **Cancel:** Returns to the *CPT Employment* page without authorizing CPT.



Any changes made to CPT
authorization display in
Event History.

View CPT Information

DSOs can view CPT information in four different locations in the student's record:

1. Student List: **Students with Curricular Practical Training (CPT)**: Accessed from *Student Lists* page.
2. *Employment Information* page: Accessed from *Student Information* page.
3. *Current Requests/Authorization Details* page: Accessed from *Student Information* page.
4. *Event History* page: Accessed from *Student Information* page.

STUDENT LIST: STUDENTS WITH CURRICULAR PRACTICAL TRAINING (CPT)

This student list allows DSOs to find students with active or future CPT authorizations quickly. A student with multiple CPT authorizations will appear on the list more than once.

EMPLOYMENT INFORMATION PAGE

SEVIS displays CPT authorizations on the *Employment Information* page.

CURRENT REQUESTS/AUTHORIZATIONS DETAILS PAGE

The *Current Requests/Authorization Details* page displays information on current and future CPT authorizations only.

STUDENT EVENT HISTORY

SEVIS captures and displays the history of CPT authorizations in the student's Event History.

Icon Guide

See the [SEVIS Help Icons](#) on the SEVIS Help Hub for a quick-reference of the icons used in this user guide.

WHAT'S NEW

Try the Facebook Chatbot

Visit the tool on the Study in the States Facebook page to learn how to become an F or M international student in the United States.

[Read more on the blog](#)

Learn About Summer Employment

While employed this summer, make sure you have all the relevant information on maintaining your student status, and the steps you must take before returning to school.

[Read more on the blog](#)

ICON GUIDE

See the [SEVIS Help Icons](#) on the SEVIS Help Hub for a quick-reference of the icons used in this user guide.

I'm Looking For

CONTACT US

SEVP Response
Center

703-603-3400

Monday -Friday
8:00 a.m. to 6:00
p.m. ET,
except holidays

SEVP@ice.dhs.gov

ICE Tip Line

[1-866-DHS-2-ICE](tel:1-866-DHS-2-ICE)

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Please provide feedback on this page.

☐ Yes

☐ No

Submit



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